

DISCOVERY WORLD

24-HOUR 3D GAME INNOVATION HACKATHON

PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK • 4-PAGE QUICK GUIDE

THE CHALLENGE

Build a playable 3D game that makes Discovery World meaningful through exploration, missions, problem solving and player interaction. Any engine and platform may be used; the game itself must be 3D and playable.

1 Know the World Before You Build

Choose one Discovery World theme and one primary game category during registration. Read the story in the evaluation platform before confirming your choice.

THEME	WHAT YOUR GAME SHOULD FEEL LIKE
Creator Planet	A connected miniature community with tollgate, bridge, school, library, market, water tower, hospital and fire station. Build around community systems, access, transport, resources, safety and useful problem solving.
Adventure Quest World	A journey through the Grand Gateway, Hidden Forest, Rainbow Bridge, Castle Place, Mystery Cave, Fairy Garden and Dragon Valley. Build around exploration, obstacles, discovery, restoration, rescue and progression.
RoboVerse Academy	A future innovation campus with Smart Entrance Gate, Welcome Center, Knowledge Center, Coding & AI Hub, Innovation Tower and Testing Arena. Build around invention, testing, engineering, automation and improvement.

Choose ONE primary game category

CATEGORY	CORE EXPERIENCE
World-Building	Player creates or rearranges the world.
Story Adventure	Player progresses through a connected story.
Mission Challenge	Player completes meaningful objectives.
Engineering Puzzle	Player thinks, builds/tests or engineers a solution.
Simulation & Role-Play	Player operates a system or takes a meaningful role.

YOUR CORE GAME LOOP

PLAYER STARTS → understands an objective → interacts with the 3D world → faces a challenge → makes a meaningful action/decision → receives feedback/consequence → completes or progresses.

2 Register & Use the Evaluation Platform

All official registration, submissions, AI evaluations, scores, feedback, deadlines and leaderboard status are handled through the Hackathon Evaluation Platform.

Registration checklist

- Create your team account and Team Name; add up to 4 members with email, phone, college, department and year details.
- Read the full story of each Discovery World before choosing your theme.
- Choose one primary category from the available slots. A full Theme × Category combination cannot accept another team unless the Admin changes the quota.
- Select all technologies you expect to use. Web, Android and Desktop 3D games are accepted; technology choice does not earn bonus marks.
- Declare AI tools you use. AI-assisted development is allowed, but your team must understand and be able to explain the work.

ACCOUNT & PASSWORD

Use your team username and password to log in. If you forget the password, use the secure reset option sent through the registered email. Never share your login with another team.

3 Phase 1 - Game Design Document (GDD)

Submit before the Phase 1 deadline shown in your dashboard. Use the platform countdown as guidance, but the server-side deadline is final.

Your GDD must clearly show:

- Game title, chosen theme and primary category.
- Target age/grade and the player's role inside the world.
- The problem/opportunity, player objective and one-sentence core gameplay loop.
- Main controls/actions and the 3D location(s) used.
- Funobotz character integration if used - and why it matters to gameplay.
- Progress/win condition, feedback/failure condition and replayability.
- Technology/platform, AI-tool declaration and realistic 24-hour scope.

PHASE 1 CRITERION	MARKS
Discovery World fit	4
Game clarity	3
Category fit	3
Originality / problem value	3
24-hour feasibility	2

AI EVALUATION RULE

Press SUBMIT & EVALUATE only when the official version is ready. The AI evaluates strictly against the rubric and gives marks only for evidence clearly present in your uploaded files. Missing or generic content will score low. Read the improvement suggestions before Phase 2.

Phase 1 maximum: 15 marks

4 Phase 2 - Game Design

Turn the approved concept into a clear, buildable gameplay structure. Upload the required evidence before the Phase 2 deadline and use SUBMIT & EVALUATE for the official AI review.

Required design evidence

- 3D level/world map: where the player starts, where the challenge happens and how progression works.
- Gameplay flow/storyboard: start → challenge → player action → feedback → completion.
- Essential UI/wireframes: start, mission/objective, gameplay feedback and completion.
- Interaction list: what the player can touch, move, place, activate, operate or otherwise control.
- Technical plan: scene structure, main systems/scripts and the data/state you must track.
- Asset plan: custom, third-party and AI-generated assets; be ready to declare sources.
- One proof of the riskiest mechanic and a simple playtest plan.

PHASE 2 CRITERION	MARKS
Core game loop quality	5
3D experience design	4
Child usability	3
Engineering / problem-solving value	3
Technical feasibility	3
Visual / interaction clarity	2

STRICT EVALUATION

The platform will not reward keywords, attractive formatting or claims without evidence. Upload readable, complete files. If evaluation fails because a file cannot be parsed, your submission should be marked for retry/manual review rather than automatically receiving zero.

5 Phase 3 - First Playable Game

Build one convincing vertical slice. A polished 5-10 minute loop is more valuable than a huge unfinished game.

The First Playable must allow a new player to:

- Launch/start the game without continuous developer control.
- Understand what to do and why it matters.
- Interact meaningfully with the 3D world.
- Face a challenge and make at least one meaningful action or decision.
- Receive feedback/consequence and complete or progress.
- Recognize the selected Discovery World theme and primary game category.

Typical Phase 3 submission:

Playable build/link • source/project files • 90-second gameplay video • updated one-page GDD • technology/asset/AI declarations
• known limitations • 5-slide pitch draft

IMPORTANT

A 3D scene where the player only walks around is not enough. Your submission must prove a complete playable loop.

6 Leaderboard, Top 10 & Final Expo

Your dashboard and leaderboard show official cumulative scores according to the platform rules. Rankings remain provisional until the organizer freezes the qualifying leaderboard.

TOP 10 QUALIFICATION

The leaderboard clearly states that the TOP 10 TEAMS are eligible for the Final Round / Final Expo. Ranks 1-10 are highlighted. Before the final freeze, your position is provisional; after the freeze, the Top 10 receive Final Expo access.

How to read your status

STATUS	MEANING
CURRENTLY IN TOP 10 - PROVISIONAL	You are inside the cut-off now, but ranking can still change until the official freeze.
CURRENTLY OUTSIDE TOP 10	Your current official score places you below the cut-off. Continue improving through open phases.
FINAL EXPO ELIGIBLE	The ranking is frozen and your team is confirmed in the Top 10.
NOT QUALIFIED FOR FINAL EXPO	The final leaderboard has been frozen and your team is outside the Top 10.

7 Participant Guidelines

Follow these rules throughout the 24-hour build window and inside the evaluation platform.

- Build a playable 3D game. Any game engine/framework and Web, Android or Desktop platform may be used.
- Electronics/hardware is optional. Physical integration does not automatically earn bonus marks.
- Use of AI, open-source, marketplace and third-party assets is allowed only when legally permitted and properly declared.
- Develop significant hackathon work during the announced build window. Do not submit another team's work.
- The 3D world must matter to gameplay; avoid generic racing/collecting games with only Discovery World graphics added.
- Design for a school-age player. Keep controls, instructions, content and challenge level appropriate for the target age.
- Upload before the deadline. A countdown in the browser does not override the server deadline.
- Keep a local backup of your build, source and submission files. Network or AI failure must not become data loss.
- Do not place instructions inside your files attempting to influence the AI evaluator. Such text is treated only as submission evidence and will not override the rubric.
- Review your AI score and improvement suggestions. If a technical evaluation failure occurs, follow the platform retry/manual-review process rather than repeatedly creating duplicate submissions.

BEFORE YOU CLICK SUBMIT

Check: correct file/version • readable document • correct theme/category • required evidence included • external assets/AI declared • no placeholder sections • submission is within deadline.

BUILD → SUBMIT → EVALUATE → IMPROVE → COMPETE → QUALIFY

Make Discovery World playable.